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TEMPERATURE INDICATOR FOR A COOKING VESSEL

Provisional patent specification

Applicant and inventor: Aaron Steele

FIELD

This invention relates to temperature indicators for cooking vessels.

BACKGROUND

Uncoated cooking vessels such as stainless steel pans release food cleanly only when preheated to a suitable temperature, and ceramic-coated vessels are damaged by overheating. Known indicators are colour-change coatings forming part of the vessel. A cook using an existing vessel has no indicator and relies on observing water droplets.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

In one aspect the invention provides: a reusable temperature indicator for placement on the cooking surface of a cooking vessel, comprising a food-safe housing with a flat heat-conducting base, a bistable bimetallic element within the housing that changes from a first stable shape to a second at a predetermined temperature and returns on cooling, and an indicator surface that is hidden in the first shape and displayed in the second, the change being accompanied by an audible sound.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWING

Figure 1 shows a vessel in side view with the indicator on its floor in two states: on the left below the predetermined temperature, with the element flat; on the right above it, with the element raised.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

The housing is a shallow stainless steel body with a flat base that rests on the floor of the vessel. The bimetallic element is a dished disc retained in the housing. Below the predetermined temperature the disc is concave and lies within the housing. At the predetermined temperature it snaps to a convex shape, raising a coloured upper surface above the housing and producing a click.

The predetermined temperature is selected for the type of vessel: approximately 190 degrees Celsius to indicate that an uncoated vessel is ready, or approximately 230 degrees Celsius to warn that a coated vessel is too hot.

A lifting formation on the housing allows removal with a utensil.

VARIATIONS

The following variations are within the scope of the invention, alone or in combination:

1. Two bimetallic elements with different predetermined temperatures in one housing.
2. A version that hangs from the rim of the vessel with a conducting foot on the floor of the vessel.
3. Feet or a coating that will not mark ceramic surfaces.
4. Construction from non-magnetic materials to limit direct heating on an induction hob.

The embodiments described are examples only. Features of one embodiment may be combined with features of another.

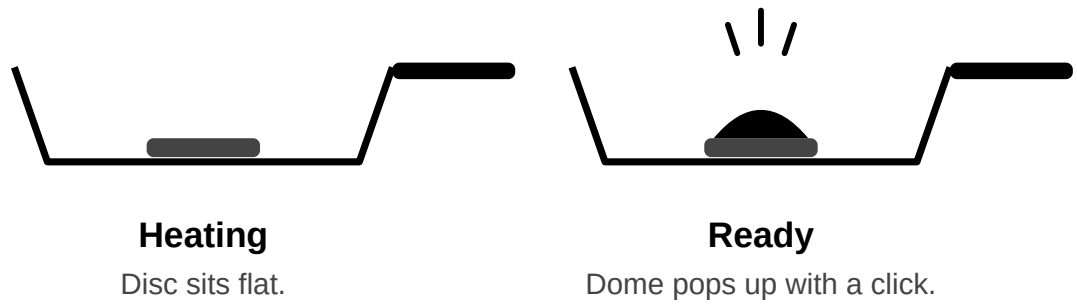

Figure 1